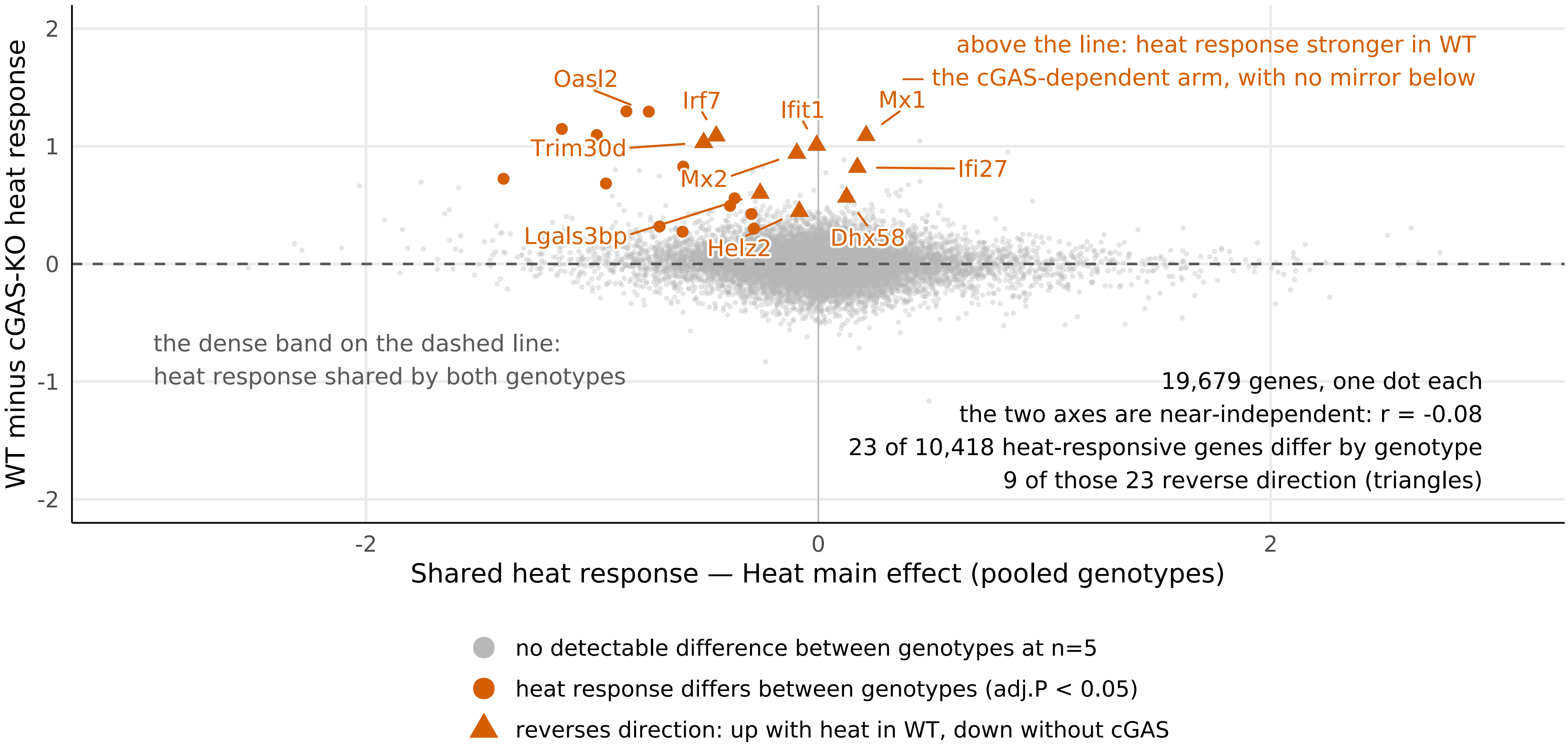
# Two separate threads: a shared temperature response and a small cGAS-dependent arm

Each dot is one gene, in log2 fold change. x = its heat response averaged over both genotypes, y = how much stronger that response is in WT than in cGAS-KO. Typical sizes: 0.15 on x against 0.06 on y, and the vertical axis is drawn 1.5× the horizontal so the small arm is visible at all.




All 23 genes in the arm respond to heat more strongly in WT than in cGAS-KO; 0 do the reverse. Every one of them falls with heat once cGAS is gone (22 of 23 individually significant), and 9 rise with heat in WT instead -- an interferon response that heat sustains only when cGAS is present. The genotype comparison of the heat response is a single-degree-of-freedom test at n=5 per group, the least-powered contrast in this design, so 23 genes is a floor on the cGAS-dependent arm rather than its full size. Genes on the shared axis have no detectable cGAS-dependence at n=5, which is a weaker statement than independence.